QLooper RC1 - your first loop

QLooper includes a modified Element host. You do **not** need a separate Element installation. Some menus and internal nodes still use the Element name.

1. Install and select your audio device

1. Open the DMG and drag **QLooper.app** to **Applications**. Eject the DMG and open the copied app. Use this build: stock Element does not contain our nodes. Choose the Apple Silicon build. macOS 14 is the build minimum; RC1 has been tested locally on macOS 26, not on every older macOS release.

2. This initial RC1 is not notarized. If macOS blocks it, follow Apple's Open Anyway procedure in **System Settings > Privacy & Security**, after verifying the download source. Do not disable Gatekeeper globally.

3. Allow microphone/audio-input access when requested. Double-click the device status at the bottom of the main window to open audio settings, then choose your audio interface for input and output; enable the channels you use.

4. Start at **44.1 or 48 kHz**, **128 or 256 samples**. Use headphones for microphone tests to avoid acoustic feedback. Start with output volume low.

2. Add and connect a Looper

1. Create a new session/graph. Show the **Plugins** panel, find **Looper** among the built-in Element nodes and drag it into the graph. The Plugins panel is in the left sidebar; View > Plugin Manager also lists the available modules. The expected names are Looper, Looper Manager and Song Manager. No plugin scan is required for our built-in nodes.

2. Connect **Audio In > Looper > Audio Out**. For a mono instrument, connect its input channel to both Looper input channels to hear it in both ears. Connect Looper left/right outputs to the output pair feeding your headphones/speakers.

3. Double-click the Looper to open its full editor. **Monitor** enables hearing the live input; **Mute** silences recorded loops; **Bypass** passes input through.

4. For a first test select **Settings > General > Mode > Free**. In **Settings > Recording**, set the Overdub start timing to **Now** for this first test; leave **Stop after** off. Close Settings to return to the controls.

5. Click **Overdub** to start the first recording; click again to finish it and hear it repeat. Click Overdub again to add another layer, then again to finish.

6. **Play/Stop** toggles playback. **Undo/Redo** works on an entire recording/One Take. Record has its own configurable behaviour; inspect Settings > Recording before using it on material you want to keep.

7. **File > Save Session As...** saves your session and layers. Keep a backup before tests.

When the looper editor has keyboard focus and you are not editing text: **A** = Overdub, **S** = Record, **D** = Play/Stop, **Z/X** = Undo/Redo. The labels in the current editor show the shortcuts. MIDI is optional.

3. Work with layers and timing

- Layers have volume/pan, Add/Replace, On, Solo and No FB (ignore feedback). The waveform shows the recorded audio, independent of its current volume.

- **Layers...** opens the larger window. Select a waveform for a larger preview.

- **Import** loads prepared audio; files are resampled as needed, not time-stretched.

- **Sync** follows rig tempo; **Fixed bars** sets the initial loop length in bars. Configure start/count-in separately for Record, Overdub and the custom profiles.

- Hover a control for a short explanation. In Settings, **?** opens detailed help.

4. Add a Looper Manager

1. Add another Looper and a **Looper Manager** from the built-in nodes.

2. Wire the Manager's **MIDI output to each Looper's MIDI input** in that graph. Connect the hardware MIDI input to the Manager if you use shared pedals.

3. Open the Manager. Its boxes control individual loopers; **Play All / Stop All** control the group. **Active** identifies the looper receiving shared commands.

4. Drag a compatible looper's header into **Master**; assign other loopers to **Linked** or leave them **Independent**. Linking has compatibility/recording restrictions and never means automatic time-stretching of imported audio.

5. Assign your controller in **Settings > MIDI**. Hold actions need both press and release messages (for example MIDI CC values 127 and 0).

5. Sections and the combined view

- Prepare section graphs (for example Verse and Chorus), with their audio paths connected to the parent graph. Each can contain its own Looper Manager/effects.

- Add **Song Manager** at the parent level. Add the prepared sections to its list in the order you need. Next section uses its timing settings; a double-click on a section switches immediately. **Panic** silences the song; **Restore audio** restores sound without restarting stopped loops.

- Open **Window > Looper View**. It brings Song Manager, Looper Manager, the shown Looper and layers together. Missing modules are shown as empty areas.

- The arrows above the looper change the **displayed** looper. Use the Manager to change MIDI/pedal control. Split / Loopers / Layers changes the space allocation.

Optional effects, tuner and metronome

Add your own compatible AU/VST3/LV2 effects in Element's plugin panel and route **Audio In > effect > Looper > Audio Out** to record that effect, or put effects after the looper to process playback. Install/scan external plugins separately.

The compact tuner integration expects x42 Instrument Tuner and our optional compact UI. TICK is an external metronome; neither binary is included in this first DMG. The top Metronome checkbox controls a matching TICK node when present. Looping itself needs neither plugin. Keep metronome audio on a separate output path if you do not want it recorded in the loop.

If there is no sound

- Check audio device, enabled channels and cables from input through to output.

- Check Monitor, Mute, Bypass, mixer level and Song Manager's active section/Panic.

- Rig transport and loop playback are separate controls; transport Play alone does not necessarily play a stopped loop.

- For a useful bug report: include RC1 version, macOS, device, sample rate/buffer, exact actions and whether the fault is audible in a Recorder capture.